



OHIO RIVER TRAIL FEASIBILITY STUDY

April 14, 2010

PRELIMINARY REVIEW OF ROUTING ALTERNATIVES

Section 100 – Monaca Borough to Center Township

Constraints

1. Monaca-Rochester Bridge – The sidewalk on the east side of the bridge is 5' wide which would require dismounting for bicyclist. There is a 3' shoulder on the northbound travel lane and a 5' shoulder on the southbound travel lane.
2. Atlantic and Indiana Avenues are one-way pairs which require that bicycle traffic routing be split by street/direction.
3. Atlantic Avenue does not extend to 17th Street which makes it in an incomplete pair to Indiana Avenue.
4. 9th Street has high traffic volumes at the intersection at Atlantic Avenue and 9th Street has large turning radii and long crossing distances.
5. The water tower and concrete foundation in front of the Moor Industrial Park are close to cartway creating an obstruction for a potential side path.
6. The large industrial building located at the intersection of Route 51 and Industrial Park Road, at the entrance of Colona Transfer, is very narrow and has poor site lines.
7. Beaver County Industrial Park is gated today creating a barrier to extend the trail.

Options/Alternatives

1. Sign on-road route on 9th Street from Monaca Rochester Bridge to Pennsylvania Avenue and from 9th Street to the Boat Launch
2. Alternative A – Sign on-road route on Atlantic and Indiana Avenues following existing one-way pairs, northbound route would require routing from school district field to Washington Avenue and then back to Atlantic Avenue.
3. Alternative B – Convert Atlantic and Indiana Avenues to two-way streets and sign a two-way on-road route via Atlantic Avenue to 16th Street and then to Indiana Avenue to an alleyway on the east side of the school district field.
4. Alternative C – Utilize Washington Avenue as an existing two-way street and sign as an on-road route.
5. Create a new 10' wide multi-use trail routed down alleyway to the east of the school district field towards the river and underneath the E. Rochester Bridge.
6. Trail would travel around the perimeter of the industrial area to Route 51 and then via Industrial Park Road.

7. From the cemetery south, the trail would become a 10' wide side path on the railroad side of the future Woodlawn Road extension from Aliquippa.
8. If industrial area is redeveloped for mixed-use, a public setback from river should be created with a multi-use trail or river's edge promenade to create a more desirable trail linkage.

Section 200 – Center Township to the City of Aliquippa

Constraints

1. BET-TECH Portion – The ability to create a continuous road from Industrial Park Road to Woodlawn Road in Aliquippa needs to be determined, including creating a new 10' wide side path with a 5' wide buffer on the railroad side of the roadway.
2. BCED Portion – Existing engineered drawings can allow for a 10' wide side path and a 3' wide shoulder. Location of existing obstructions may require that side path be located on the river's side of the roadway which has more curb cuts and therefore is less desirable.

Options/Alternatives

1. Create a continuous 10' wide side path with a 5' wide planted buffer along the railroad side of Woodlawn Road through this entire section.

Section 300 – City of Aliquippa to Hopewell Township

Constraints

1. Topography, available right-of-way and site lines along Woodlawn Road in the vicinity of the Franklin Avenue and the tunnel under the railroad create challenges for locating a trail.
2. Trail routing must accommodate existing conditions and proposed recommendations in the City of Aliquippa's recently adopted Revitalization Plan.
3. Ownership of Woodlawn Road south of the Ambridge-Aliquippa Bridge is unclear.

Options/Alternatives

1. Create a continuous 10' wide side path with a 5' wide planted buffer along the railroad side of Woodlawn Road through this entire section.
2. Create a signed on-road feeder route along Franklin Avenue connecting the downtown area to the trail and the riverfront.
3. Create a 10' wide side path along the north side of the proposed connector roadway from Woodland Road to the proposed public access riverfront area.

Section 400 – Hopewell Township, South Heights Borough and Crescent Township

Constraints

1. Active water dependent industrial uses between the Power Plant and Work Street creates a barrier for riverfront trail connections.
2. McGovern Blvd/Route 51's alignment is directly adjacent to railroad right-of-way in portions of this segment which creates a barrier for trail alignment.
3. Existing clusters of neighborhood streets lack inter-connections to create continuous on-road route.
4. The narrow tunnel along North Street has poor site lines.
5. The mix of land uses along Route 51 varies from post-industrial to small residential dwellings located relatively close to the roadway with on-street parking and multiple curb-cuts, limiting the ability to create on-road and side path trail connections.

Options/Alternatives

1. Alternative A1 – The trail would consist of a 10' wide multi-use trail through multiple riverfront parcels from North Road to the Power Plant bridge over the railroad and potentially continue to Main Street.
2. Alternative A2 – The trail would extend from Power Plant bridge down to Main Street via a rails-and-trails configuration along the CSX right-of-way.
3. Alternative B – This alternative would consist of a 10' wide side path along the Reliant Power Plant substation frontage along Route 51 from the Power Plant Road to the residential areas and travel on-road to Maple Street.
4. Alternative C – On-road route via Route 51 from Maple Street to Main Street and via Main Street to Ferry Road to connect via the tunnel under the railroad to Dashields Lock Road.
5. Alternative D - This would consist of an on-road route via Route 51 to Brockwood Road and Prospect Street to Dashields Lock Road.
6. Alternative E – On-road trail via Dashields Lock Road to ACOE Lock Facility and south to Moon Township
7. Alternative F- On-road route via Route 51/Stoops Ferry Road, over the hill to University Boulevard.

Section 500 – Crescent Township to Moon Township

Constraints

1. Dramatic topography along river creates a narrow shelf to accommodate railroad right-of-way with limited ability for additional facilities.
2. Topography along Route 51/Stoops Ferry Road creates a major hurdle for on-road bicycling over the hill.
3. CSX owned right-of-way extends to river's edge in the area of the existing motorcycle dealership.
4. Traffic volumes along this segment of Route 51 are high and roadway design in segment near Sewickley Bridge has limited-access characteristics not conducive for bicycle and pedestrian traffic.

Options/Alternatives

1. Alternative E (from Section 400) – The trail would consist of either an on-road route or river's edge promenade along the ACOE access road from Shouse Park to Lock Building. From that point a 10' wide multi-use trail would travel between the inner and outer fences up-slope from the lock facilities through ACOE properties south, towards Moon Township. In the area of the existing motorcycle dealership, where P&LE Stoops Ferry station platform remains exist, a boardwalk would extend for approximately 1200 linear feet. The trail would extend south, parallel to the CSX right-of-way through several parcels owned by the Moon Township Authority in the vicinity of the Sewickley Bridge. The trail would cross the railroad tracks at the existing private at-grade crossing for the Moon Township Authority parcel targeted for a new riverfront public park. The trail would continue south, as a 10' wide path, along the south side of the CSX tracks via a Duquesne Power right-of-way to just north of the 4th Avenue intersection with American Bridge Way.
2. Alternative F (from Section 400) – On-road route via Route 51/Stoops Ferry Road and University Boulevard. This segment generally has wide shoulders to accommodate on-road cyclists but is hindered by topography, traffic volumes and traffic speeds.

Section 600 – Moon Township, Coraopolis Borough to Montour Trail Mile Post '0" (Moon Township)

Constraints

1. The Montour Trail extension through the Montour Junction property to Montour Street is cut-off from river by the CSX railroad.
2. The one-way street pairs, 4th and 5th Avenues and the block of Mill Street between the two, create complicated on-road bicycle routing.
3. The Borough's maintenance facilities are located on the river's edge which creates a barrier for public access along river's edge and is a poor utilization of desirable frontage.
4. There are multiple land-locked parcels along the riverfront that cannot be developed due to access and location within the floodplain, yet could provide vital trail linkages.

Options/Alternatives

1. The trail would extend via a widened sidewalk to create a side path on the east side of American Bridge Way from 4th Avenue to the approximate location of what would be 3rd Avenue along the property boundary of the American Bridge property.
2. A 10' wide multi-use trail would be created parallel to the CSX right-of-way along the perimeter of the American Bridge parcel. It appears that there is no right-of-way existing for what would have been 3rd Avenue although it appears on some maps.
3. The trail would continue as a signed on-road route via Watts to Birch Alley. Today this alley is a gravel pot-holed roadway with fences lining both sides for the entire block. The width of the roadway is 17'.

4. The trail would continue via a signed on-road route to 1st Avenue and travel from Main Street to Chestnut. A supplemental multi-use trail or river's edge promenade could be created from the senior housing complex through the public works facility to the existing riverfront public park.
5. Alternative A – The trail would consist of a 10' wide multi-use trail through multiple riverfront parcels from Chestnut Street, through the Stuckey Industrial parcel and several landlocked riverfront parcels, east to Royal Avenue. There is a boat club located at the north end of Royal Avenue. The trail would run along the perimeter of this property, parallel to the CSX right-of-way to gain access to Royal Avenue.
6. Alternative B – The alternative consists of an on-road route via 4th and 5th Avenues. 4th Avenue is currently a wide one-way roadway with two through-travel lanes and parking on both sides. After multiple site visits, it appears that the parking along this roadway is rarely utilized. One option would remove the parking lane on the river's side of the roadway and replace it with a 6' wide bike lane and 3' shoulder. In contrast, 5th Avenue has one wide through-lane and parking on both sides. The roadway is not wide enough to accommodate a dedicated bike lane and it appears that parking is well utilized on both sides of this street. This route would be designated as a "sharrow." One issue with this alternative is the short one-way segment of Mill Street between 4th and 5th Avenues. The proposed on-road route would travel south on Mill Street towards 4th Avenue. Currently Mill Street is one-way in the opposite direction. This one-way segment would need to be reversed; otherwise the on-road route would need to travel along Main Street.
7. Alternative C – This alternative would utilize Pine Alley, located between 4th and 5th Avenue, as a two-way on-road route to connect Montour Street to Broadway, Mill Street and Main Street. The concept of a green alley is to upgrade a traditional service alleyway with improved "green" urban stormwater management facilities, landscaping and lighting to create inviting pedestrian and bicycle environment on an existing facility that has relatively low and slow vehicular traffic.